

Conflict Global Storm

Let's face it—tactical first person shooters are a dime a dozen. In fact, they're a dime a thousand, with each new game more stereotyped than the one before it. Ergo, there's a very good reason that only a few of them are ever really successful. And *C:GS* does *not* come under that category.

The idea is good enough (even if it's a tad unoriginal): you're put in charge of a tactical squad of four called Red Team, which consists of Sergeant Bradley, Corporal Jones, Corporal Connors, Corporal Foley, and later, Corporal Sherman as well. Naturally, you're sent into a number of hostile locations throughout the game—ranging from Russia to Kashmir! The idea is straightforward—complete the mission by any means necessary and get the hell outta there! Simple enough—or so you'd think.

Unfortunately, the game is marred by a number of basic errors that ruin its playability. Take the AI for example. The user's manual proudly claims that AI has been significantly improved since the last installment, which makes you wonder if anyone but the worst novice had trouble completing it. The fact is that the AI is *extremely* dumb! Apparently, running straight into you from all directions is the only way your opponents know how to kill. Sure, there is the odd exception, but that doesn't matter because it upsets your "sit in a corner—aim—shoot" tactic only for a little while.

And it's not like your team is any better. They might be corporals, but they're dumb enough to be toilet cleaning privates. Their aim is worse than that of my arthritic grandma, and they waste bullets like they come for free. This is ironic really, because the bullets *do* appear to come for free! The amount of ammunition available throughout the level is so unreal, it's not funny! Each squad member seems to be able to carry a pistol, a knife, an assault rifle, medkits, grenades of multiple varieties, and hundreds of rounds of ammo for each weapon. What are they feeding these guys?

Speaking of medkits, the unbelievable health system in this game will have you *ROTFL*. Would you believe the best tactic for healing yourself is to let yourself die? Yup, some genius at Pivotal Games decided that a medkit should fully restore your health, no matter when you use it. And the icing on the cake—even if you die, the mission fails only if each and every squad member dies!

So the most effective way of using medkits is to wait till a member dies, then go revive him with a medkit, and voila—he's back to full health! It makes you wonder: are the guys at Pivotal retarded, or do they think we are retarded?

It's not all gloom and doom though. What the AI lacks in intelligence, it makes up for in numbers. So you'll always be kept on your toes when under attack.

There's also the occasional battle that will actually be difficult and might even require multiple tries before you succeed. The graphics are good, too, with lots of nice touches like bullet holes in walls and even

butterflies flying around! The squad control is not really intuitive or in-depth, but good enough for the game.

At the end of the day, *C:GS* could have been a good game, but some basic flaws make it an average game at best. It's certainly good entertainment and quite often a laugh riot, but for all the wrong reasons. The bottomline—it's a good way to kill time, but not worth it if you want to play a real game. Five on 10! ☒

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